

of a group of admen who took market research beyond statistics and applied it on a subconscious level. Othmer quotes him as saying, “Good advertising doesn’t just circulate information. It penetrates the public mind with desires and beliefs.”

Motivational research hasn’t disappeared, though it might now be categorized under market research. Market research has become the key to getting a handle on how consumers behave. In a highly competitive world, companies can’t afford to take chances on ideas without looking at what customers want and how they behave in attaining it. Increasingly, they are realizing that the best way to gain understanding of the relationship between people and products is through direct observation of the consumer. Once a radical-sounding, somewhat controversial phenomenon, market research is now accepted as the norm among marketers. Today, most companies and ad agencies employ psychologists or an anthropologist trained in ethnology—the science that breaks down humans into categories like race, culture, sex, and income level, as a part of their mainstream market research.



If you’ve ever noticed someone observing you in a store (and if they’re good at their job, you *won’t* even be aware of them) it may not be a secret